

Q+A

COMING INTO HER OWN

IN THE PAST THREE YEARS, **ANANYA PANDAY** HAS RECEIVED HER SHARE OF OPPORTUNITIES, BUT IT'S ONLY NOW THAT FILMS LIKE *GEHRAIYAAN* ARE TESTING HER METTLE AS AN ACTOR

Q. Would it be fair to say *Gehraiyaan* has given you the most layered part till now?
I think, emotionally, Tia is my most fleshed out character. Now that I have tasted blood and know what it feels like to surrender to a character, I hope I get more roles like this. It's cool to see women who are strong, complex and flawed, who are not judged by the filmmaker and, hopefully, the audience.

Q. Given *Gehraiyaan*'s adult rating, do you think it is likely to find a wider audience on streaming?
Gehraiyaan is a film that you can enjoy at home, reflect upon and then talk to a friend about. I'm happy it's releasing on Amazon Prime. OTT gives you the option of switching off something you don't like. At least we know people will try watching it.

Q. Infidelity forms the core of this relationship drama. How did you get into Tia's head?
I had to borrow a lot from myself. I haven't been cheated on, but I do have some of Tia's personality traits. I am insecure as a person and when I'm in a relationship. Tia is very loyal, loving and dependent on her partner. In some small ways, I do possess these qualities. I need to work on that.

Q. Your childhood friends Shanaya [Kapoor] and Suhana [Khan], too, are set to become actors. Any advice for them?
Ours was a collective dream to become actors. Shanaya, especially, turns to me whenever confused. I try not to give too much *gyaan*. I tell them about my experiences, but I want them to have their own lovely experiences.

–with Suhani Singh